FAMILY DEVOTIONS FOR THE WEEK

Faith Formation for Families • The Congregation at Prayer • Week of September 20–26, 2026

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Invocation

In the name of the Father and of the ✠ Son and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

Introit (see back page)

Memory Verse for the Week — Nahum 1:7

"The Lord is good, a stronghold in the day of trouble; He knows those who take refuge in Him."

Daily Readings: LSB p. 299

Sun: Nehemiah 4:7–23; 1 Timothy 3:1–16
Mon: Nehemiah 5:1–16; 6:1–9, 15–16; 1 Timothy 4:1–16
Tue: Nehemiah 7:1–4; 8:1–18; 1 Timothy 5:1–16
Wed: Nehemiah 9:1–21; 1 Timothy 5:17—6:2
Thu: Nehemiah 9:22–38; 1 Timothy 6:3–21
Fri: Malachi 1:1–14; Matthew 3:1–17
Sat: Malachi 2:1—3:5; Matthew 4:1–11

Talk About It This Week

Each day, read the appointed readings (or just one), then ask: *Where did we hear God's Word planted today? What is God teaching us to trust?* Day-by-day questions for younger and older children are in the daily devotion pages (and on the web page).

In Our Prayers This Week (LSB Daily Prayer Themes)

✠ **Sun:** the joy of the resurrection; fruit of faith in all who heard the Word today
✠ **Mon:** our Baptism, callings, and daily work; schools; good government and peace
✠ **Tues:** deliverance from temptation and evil; the addicted and despairing
✠ **Wed:** marriage and family; parents and children; our home and community
✠ **Thurs:** the Church, pastors, teachers, and missionaries; thanksgiving for the Sacrament
✠ **Fri:** the preaching of the cross; the persecuted; the sick and the dying
✠ **Sat:** faithfulness to the end; hearts made ready for the Lord's Day

Hymn of the Week: "Salvation unto Us Has Come" — LSB 555

Salvation unto us has come / By God's free grace and favor; / Good works cannot avert our doom, / They help and save us never. / Faith looks to Jesus Christ alone, / Who did for all the world atone; / He is our one Redeemer.

Apostles' Creed

Lord's Prayer

Benediction

Let us bless the Lord. **Thanks be to God.**

HOW TO USE THIS PAGE… Gather once a day — at breakfast, supper, or bedtime. Speak the Invocation, say the memory verse together, read the day's readings, talk about them, sing the hymn stanza, pray for the day's theme, and close with the Lord's Prayer and Benediction. Ten minutes is plenty. The seed does the work — "so shall My word be… it shall not return to Me empty" (Isaiah 55:11).

The Seventeenth Sunday after Pentecost (Proper 20) **September 20, 2026**

Season of Pentecost ✠ Liturgical Color: Green

Introit *Psalm 116:12–13, 15–16; antiphon: v. 17*

I will offer to you the sacrifice of thanksgiving
and call on the name of the LORD.
What shall I render to the LORD
for all his benefits to me?
I will lift up the cup of salvation
and call on the name of the LORD.
Precious in the sight of the LORD
is the death of his saints.
O LORD, I am your servant;
I am your servant, the son of your maidservant. You have loosed my bonds.
Glory be to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Spirit;
as it was in the beginning, is now, and will be forever. Amen.
I will offer to you the sacrifice of thanksgiving
and call on the name of the LORD.

Collect of the Day

Lord God, heavenly Father, since we cannot stand before You relying on anything we have done, help us trust in Your abiding grace and live according to Your Word; through Jesus Christ, Your Son, our Lord, who lives and reigns with You and the Holy Spirit, one God, now and forever. Amen.

This Sunday's Readings

Isaiah 55:6–9 · Psalm 27:1–9 · Philippians 1:12–14, 19–30 · Matthew 20:1–16

Gradual *Psalm 34:9, 19*

Oh, fear the LORD, you his saints,
for those who fear him have no lack!
Many are the afflictions of the righteous,
but the LORD delivers him out of them all.

Next Sunday's Readings (Proper 21)

Ezekiel 18:1–4, 25–32 · Psalm 25:1–10 · Philippians 2:1–4 (5–13) 14–18 · Matthew 21:23–27 (28–32)

Learn by Heart: The Sacrament of the Altar — What is the benefit of this eating and drinking? *LSB p. 326*

"These words, "Given and shed for you for the forgiveness of sins," show us that in the Sacrament forgiveness of sins, life, and salvation are given us through these words. For where there is forgiveness of sins, there is also life and salvation."

THIS WEEK AT HOME: A landowner hires workers all day long and at six o'clock pays the man who worked one hour exactly what he pays the man who worked twelve. The all-day workers are furious — and they are right that it isn't fair. It isn't. It is grace, and grace is never fair. Isaiah says it plainly this Sunday: "My thoughts are not your thoughts." This week Nehemiah's people rebuild a wall in fifty-two days and then stand for hours listening to God's Word and weeping. Ask one another: "When have we been annoyed that God was too generous with someone else?"

Kids in the Divine Service — What is a "steward"?

A steward is someone put in charge of something that belongs to another. If you are a babysitter, you are a steward for that child's parents. God has made us stewards, or keepers, of His creation — everything we have is His, given to us to use in love for Him.

So why do Christians give? Not because we owe God for what He has done in Jesus — that debt is already settled. We give because the powerful Gospel is at work in us. This week's Gospel shows a master paying far more than anyone earned; everything we hold came to us the same way.

Parents: *Talk about stewardship with your children. Help them discover how they might give from what they have — perhaps setting aside a portion of their own money each week — so they experience the joy of giving firsthand.*

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